

Openings

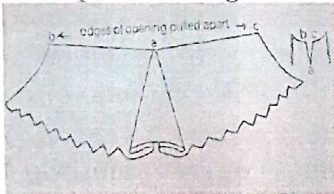
An opening is any part of the garment that provides access to the clothing. The opening must be properly constructed to provide adequate access and to last the lifespan of the garment. The type of opening chosen should be suitable for the garment, fabric and position of the opening on the garment. When choosing an opening, the type of fastening required must be considered. Commonly used openings include; continuous wrap opening, faced-slit, fly front and bound openings.

Continuous Wrap Opening

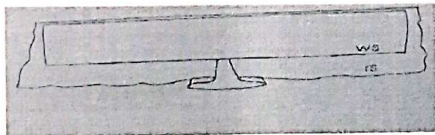
This opening is suitable for wrist opening of long sleeves, neck openings of ladies tops and men's casual shirts and the back openings of children's clothes. The opening may be fastened by buttons and loops, hooks and bars or press stands.

Preparation

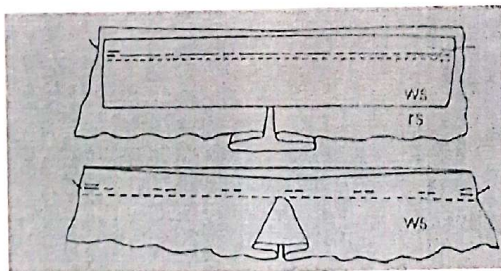
1. Cut a strip of the garment fabric twice the length of the opening and 5-7.5cm wide as appropriate for the garment. The fabric direction of the strip should match that of the garment.
2. Pull apart the edges of the opening so that they lie in a straight line.



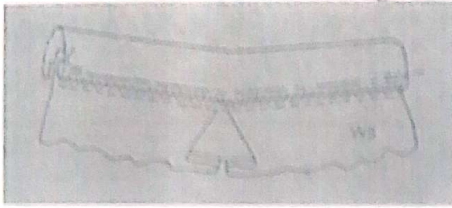
3. Place the right side of the strip to the right side of the opening, raw edges together.



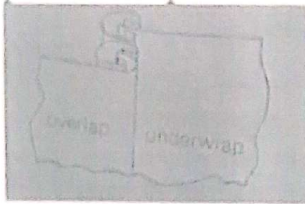
4. Tack and stitch 6mm from the raw edge. The turning on the wrong side of the garment will decrease in width towards the end of the opening but will remain the same with from the beginning to the end.



5. Make 6mm turning on free edge of strip and fold it over the raw edges of the opening. Tack turned edge just above the first stitching and hem into position. When hemming, no stitches should show on the right side.



6. Fold the front part of the opening back along the stitching line, place over the back portion and press.



Faced slit opening

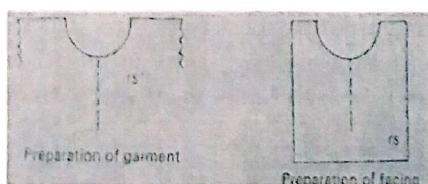
This opening is ideal for neck openings (front and back) of blouses and childrens clothing and men's casual shirts as well as wrist openings of long sleeves set in a band. The opening may be fastened by button and loop, hook and eye or zip fastener. The opening can be made decorative by:

- a) Turning the facing to the right side
- b) Working machine -stitched rows on the right side
- c) Using contrasting facing on the right side
- d) Shaping outer edges of facing and applying it on the right side.

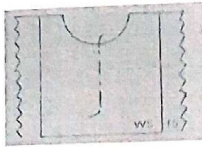
Preparation

1. Mark the position and required length of opening on the garment, making it as straight as possible.

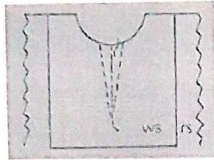
Cut facing section the length of the opening plus 5cm, and proportional width, e.g. 15cm long and 5cm wide, 20cm long and 10cm wide.



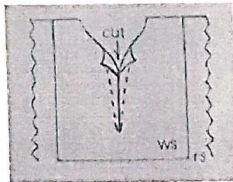
2. Place the right of facing to right side of garment. Place pins and tack through both thicknesses of material.



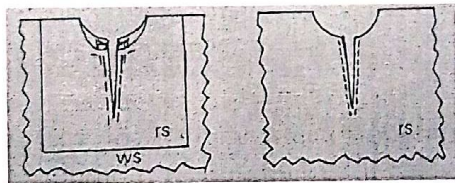
3. Machine 6mm from top of marked opening towards a point, sloping stitching inwards. Continue from point to 6mm from top at the other side.



4. Cut down the center of opening between stitching lines, snipping carefully into and not through the point



5. Turn facing to the wrong side and press flat. You may edge from the right side, ensuring that the point is secured.



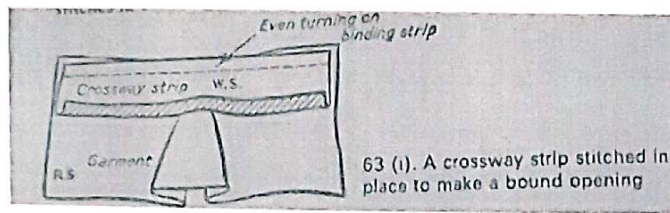
The Bound Opening

This can be used as an alternative to the faced slit opening but it is suitable for light weight fabrics, especially transparent ones. The fastenings for this opening are similar to those for the faced slit opening.

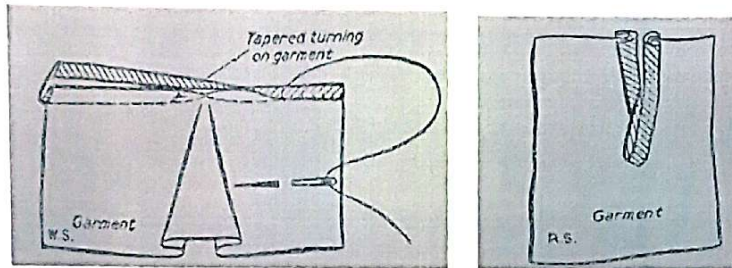
The opening is neaten using a crossway strip.

Preparation

1. Mark the opening and cut through to the end point.
2. Cut a crossway strip long enough to bind both sides of the cut and four times the finished width of the binding. Fold and iron crease the binding strip.
3. Place the right sides of the binding to the right sides of the garment with edges matching. Pin, tack and stitch close to the edge.



4. Fold the crossway strip over to the wrong side so that it binds the edges. Hem it in position over the stitching. Press in place

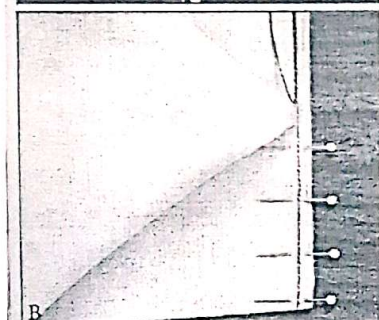
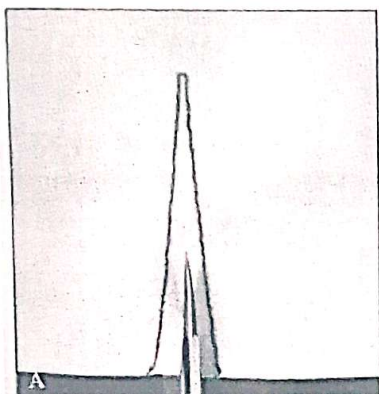


Sleeve Openings

Long sleeves with cuffs usually have openings at the cuffs to make it easy for you to slip your hands into the sleeves.

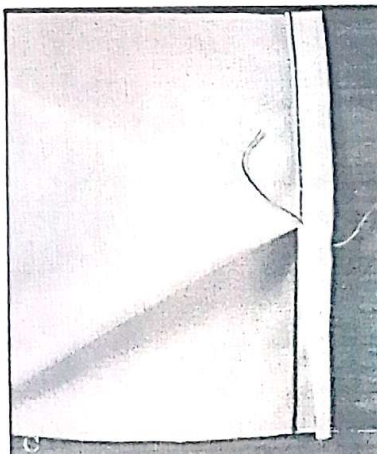
Continuous lap: For sleeves on a tailored shirt, the opening is usually bound with a straight fabric strip before the underarm seam is stitched. Your pattern will usually include a pattern piece for this strip.

To create an opening, mark the stitching lines on the lower edge of the sleeve. Stitch along these lines, using reinforcement-length stitches for 1" (2.5 cm) on either side of the point; take one stitch

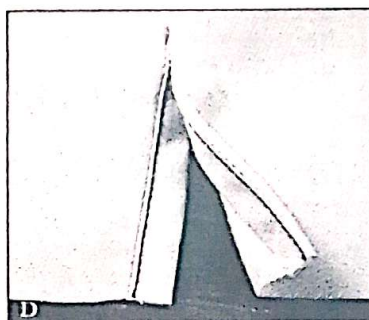


across the point. Slash between the stitching (A) right up to the point so that the opening will lie flat later. Spread the edges of the slash apart, forming an almost straight line. Pin the right side of the fabric strip to the wrong side of the slashed edge so that the sleeve stitching line is 1/4" (6 mm)

(Source: Simplicity Sewing Book)

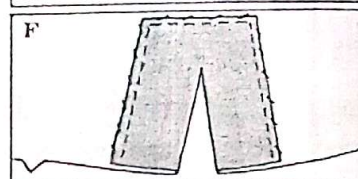
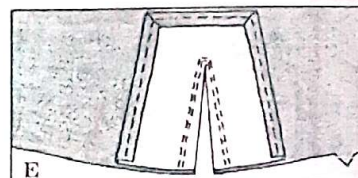


from the edge of the strip. With the sleeve right side up, fold the extra sleeve fabric out of the way and stitch 1/4" (6 mm) from the strip edge, on top of the previous stitching (B). To reinforce the seam, stitch again. Press the strip away from the sleeve and press the seam toward the strip. Then, press under 1/4" (6 mm) on the remaining long strip edge. Pin this edge over the seam on the outside of the sleeve; stitch close to the strip edge, through all layers (C). Press the front edge of the lap to the inside (D); baste.

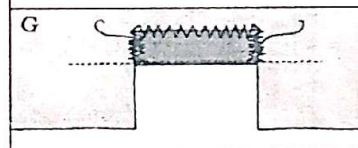


Faced opening: On casual clothes and blouses, the sleeve opening is usually faced. Your pattern will include a piece for the facing. Transfer the stitching lines and dots to the facing and to the lower edge of the sleeve. Finish the outer edges of the facing. Then, with right sides to-

gether, pin the facing to the sleeve. Stitch along the stitching line, taking one stitch across the point. To reinforce, stitch over the first stitching. Slash between the stitching up to the point (E). Press the seam toward the facing. Turn the facing to the inside of the sleeve and press. Slipstitch the finished edges in place (F).



Hemmed opening: Some sleeve patterns have small hemmed openings which you can make entirely by machine. The opening is really a seam allowance that's turned and stitched. Reinforce the seamline by stitching for 1/2" (1.3 cm) on each side of the markings. Clip to the stitching at the markings. Press the seam allowance under; then turn the raw edge under. Zigzag this edge and the ends (G).



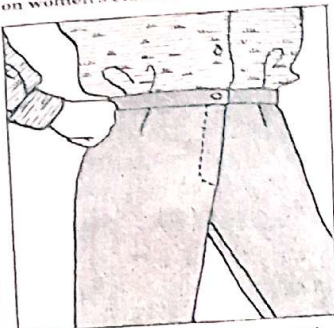
Finishing

After completing the sleeve openings, apply the cuffs as your pattern directs. Also see Cuffs, pages 117-118.

Fly-Front Opening

Fly Front Zipper/Hers

Many pants and skirts have a fly front zipper. Here's a simple way to make a fly zipper application on women's clothes.

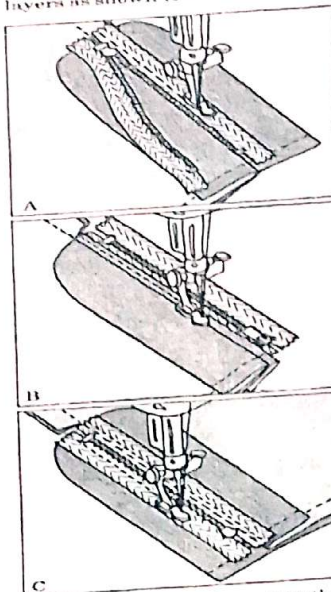


Prepare the front: First, mark the zipper stitching line on the right garment front with speed hand basting (page 88). Stitch the center front seam, backstitching at the dot marking for reinforcement and machine-basting the fly extensions together along the center front line. Clip the seam allowances below the fly extension. Press the extensions open. If your fabric ravels, finish the extension edges.

Insert the zipper: Open the zipper. Place it face down on the right side of the left fly extension only, with the coil along the seam and the top stop 1" (2.5 cm) below the waistline edge. Hold the zip-

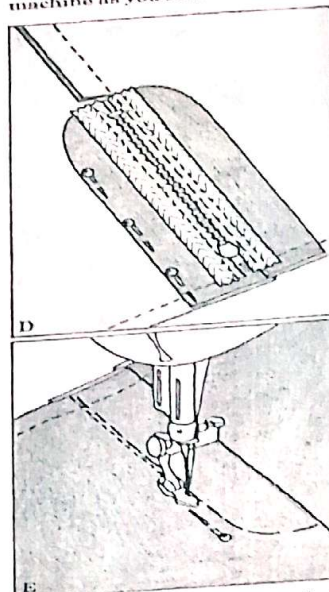
per in place with pins or double-faced basting tape. Using a zipper foot, machine-baste along the zipper tape guideline (A).

Close the zipper and turn it face up, smoothing the fabric away from it. With a zipper foot, stitch close to the fabric fold through all layers as shown (B).



Turn the zipper face down over the right fly extension only, with the pull tab turned up. Keep the rest of the garment out of the way. With a zipper foot, stitch along the zipper tape guideline, through the tape and the fly extension (C).

Spread the garment flat, wrong side up, and pin the right fly extension to the garment front (D). Then repin it from the outside, removing pins from the inside so they won't get caught in the machine as you sew.

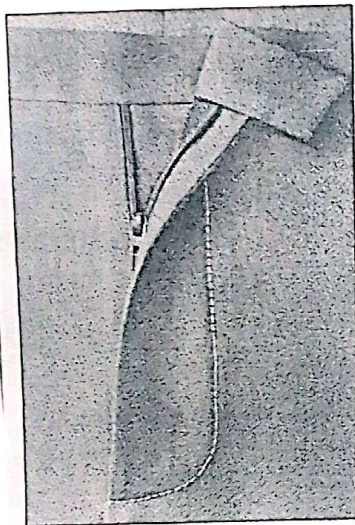


On the outside, stitch close to the baste-marked stitching line, removing the pins as you get to them (E). Remove the basting.

(Source: *Simplicity Sewing Book*)

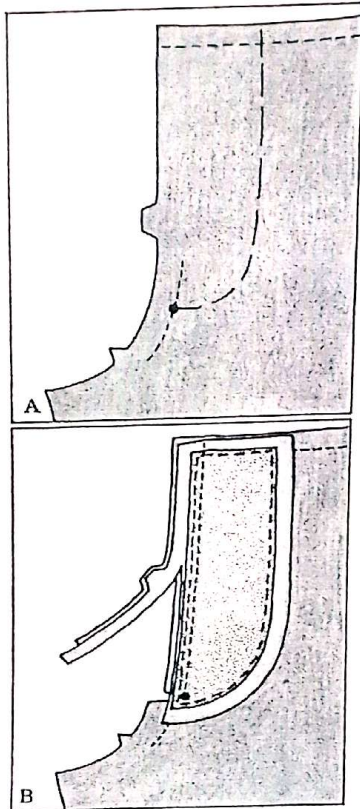
Fly Front Zipper/His

On men's and boys' pants, the left side, or overlap, of the fly is interfaced and the right side, or underlap, has an extra, lined piece called the fly shield.



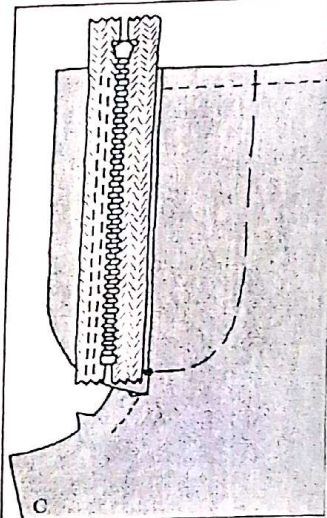
With the following method, the fly is constructed before any of the pants seams have been stitched, so it's easy to insert the zipper.

Prepare the front: Mark the zipper stitching line on the left pants front with speed hand basting (page 88). To reinforce the left front section, stitch along the center front seamline for about 1" (2.5 cm) on each side of the small dot marking, stitching through the marking (A).



Left fly: Interface the left fly. If needed, finish the curved edge. Then, with right sides together, pin the fly to the left front edge, matching notches and small dot markings. Stitch above the small dot marking. Clip the left front as far as the dot; then trim the entire fly seam allowance and the front seam allowance above the clip (B). Press the seam toward the fly and the fly away from the pants.

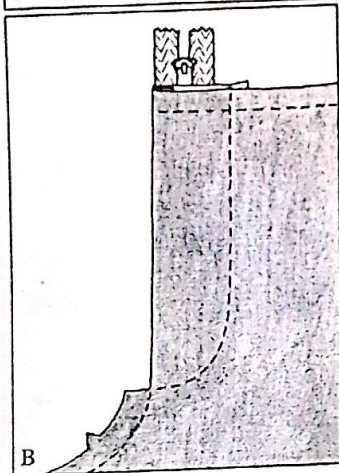
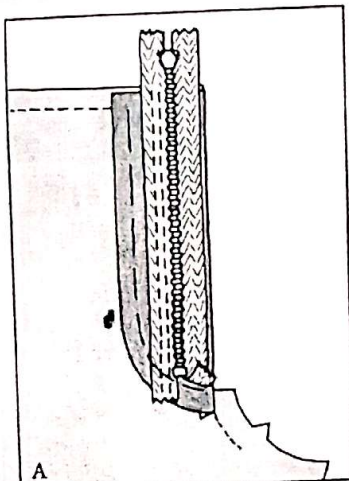
Zipper: Place the closed zipper face down over the left fly, with the bottom stop of the zipper about 1/4" (6 mm) above the small dot marking on the fly seam and the zipper tape edge close to the fly seam. The top of the zipper will



extend above the front; you'll shorten it later. Using a zipper foot, stitch close to the zipper coil as shown and again 1/4" (6 mm) from the first stitching (C).

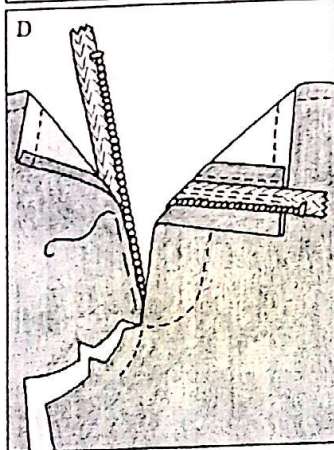
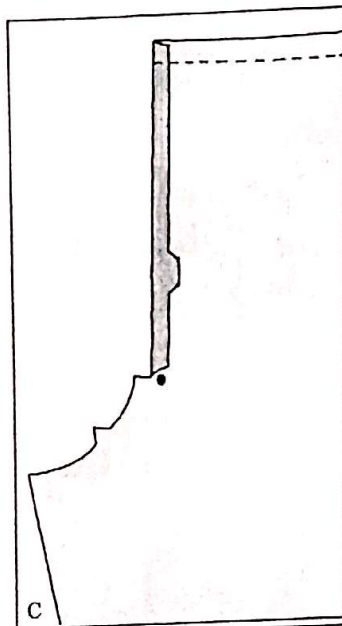
(Source: *Simplicity Sewing Book*)

Turn the fly to the inside and press. Baste or pin the fly in place, keeping the lower end of the unstitched zipper tape free (A).

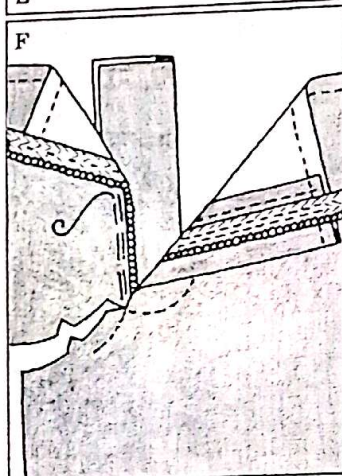
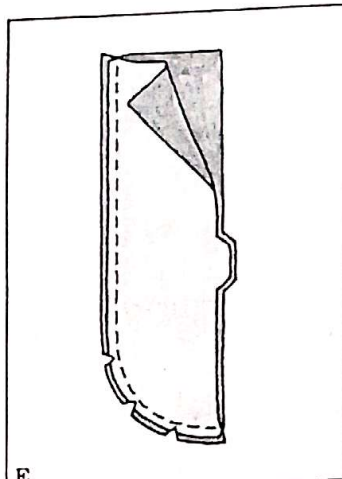


On the outside, topstitch close to the basted stitching line, still keeping the unstitched zipper tape free on the inside. Remove the basting (B).

Right fly: On the right front, make a $\frac{3}{8}$ " (1 cm) deep clip at the small dot marking on the center front seamline. Above the clip, press under $\frac{3}{8}$ " (1 cm) (C). Open the zipper. Pin the right front over the unstitched zipper tape, close to the coil, with the small dot marking about $\frac{1}{4}$ " (6 mm) below the bottom stop of the zipper; baste (D). When the zipper is closed, the left front will lap $\frac{1}{4}$ " (6 mm) over the right front and the dot markings at the lower end of the opening will match.



Fly shield: With right sides together, pin the fly lining section to the fly; stitch the curved edges together. Trim the seam and notch the curve (E). Turn the fly right side out and press.



Pin the right front $\frac{3}{8}$ " (1.5 cm) over the unstitched fly edges, with upper edges even; baste (F). Using a zipper foot, topstitch close to the zipper coil through all layers. Remove the basting.

With the zipper open, stitch across both fly sections at the waistline edge, catching in the tops of the zipper tapes. Then cut off the excess zipper so that it's even with the waistline edge.

(Source: *Simplicity Sewing Book*)